TOUCHLESS DRINKING WATER DISPENSER Made in India

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MoPure from Realment Labs helps to reduce spread of infections through taps in common establishments by dispensing drinking water when the user just places his hand over the sensor

The first scene of the movie *Project Almanac* inspired Realment Labs team to experiment with touchless and gesture control technologies. The scene shows three nerdy friends flying a drone using just their hand gestures, without touching a button or a joystick. This left Bhriju Chadha, CTO and CEO of Realment, in absolute awe of the technology.

Chadha had seen similar gesture control devices such as the Kinect earlier, but those were restricted to a larger part of the human body. He began researching various other available technologies to see if they could finetune them to a further finger-level control.

After some experimentation and pilots in previous job, Realment started gesture control services for response-based marketing for their clients, using platforms such as XTR3D, Leap Motion and Kinect combined with the Internet of Things (IoT). Initially, the goal was to put up a great show for an audience to market a brand in offline events. However, they wanted to deliver more 'wanted' value. They wanted to make a solution that solved a higher-value problem for the masses. That's when they decided to pivot into preventive healthcare using touchless technologies.

Initially, Realment had no idea what to develop. They just wanted to get into the hygiene space using touchless technologies to prevent infections. One day, Chadha asked his wife, "What do you think would be more useful for you at home or at your office if you did not have to touch it?" She replied, "Washroom taps, dustbins and drinking water dispensers!"

We have already seen foot-operated dustbins and even sensor-based dustbins that have not done well in the market. Touchless equipment have been prevalent for many years now in washrooms of malls, hotels and offices all over the world. But Realment could not find anything for the drinking water segment.

So they asked many more people the same question. Again, the top three answers were the same. This gave them some confidence on the problem area they wanted to address.

Chadha made the first prototype at home using Atmega-based Arduino and key mechanical components at minimal cost. They interacted with over 1400 urban decision-makers via phone, WhatsApp, emails, surveys and even exhibitions to get the feedback about their amateurish looking prototype. To their relief, more than 90 per cent of the people acknowledged the problem and liked the concept. They recorded the responses and feedback, evaluated what they could do to improve the product, took help of a business consultant to understand the market and applied for a provisional patent.

That is when Chadha quit his job and together with Mohith Manjunath, an already seasoned entrepreneur with over nine years of experience, formed Realment Labs to produce and market MoPure touchless dispensers for drinking water.

How to use MoPure

Problems addressed by MoPure

Hundreds of people in hospitals, offices, schools, factories, malls and other public places touch the same drinking water dispenser and spread infections that cause diarrhea, fever, fatigue, vomiting, abdominal